

DIGITAL CITIZENSHIP

Student Learning Outcomes:

After the completion of this unit students will be able to:

- ◆ Identify appropriate and inappropriate behavior while using the digital environment.
- ◆ Describe Cyber Bullying
- ◆ Describe the importance of netiquettes, being safe, responsible, and respectful while being online.
- ◆ Discuss issues of bias on digital platform.
- ◆ List improper use of computer resources.
- ◆ Describe threats and ways of actively protecting devices and networks from viruses, intrusion, vandalism, and other malicious activities.
- ◆ Discuss positive and negative impacts of using social media, both online and offline.



Introduction to unit:

This unit covers the norms of digital citizenship, emphasizing responsible and respectful behavior while using the Internet or digital devices such as computers and mobile phones.

5.1 Digital environment:

A digital environment is a space where people use devices like computers and mobile phones to connect with each other. While using it, some people behave appropriately and some do not. To know the right way to behave, follow the below rules.

5.1.1 Appropriate Online Behavior:

- ◆ **Be kind:** Use polite words in messages and chats.
- ◆ **Respect friend's privacy:** Do not share their private information or pictures.
- ◆ **Protect yourself:** Use strong passwords and never share personal details.
- ◆ **Ask first:** Check with an adult before downloading files or visit new websites.
- ◆ **Speak up:** Always tell a trusted adult if someone experiences cyberbullying or something harmful.
- ◆ **Think before posting facts or chatting:** Do not spread rumors or harmful things.

5.1.2 Inappropriate Online Behavior:

- ◆ **Being a bully:** Sending mean or hurtful messages to others.
- ◆ **Sharing confidential information:** Posting personal or friends' private information.
- ◆ **Talking to strangers:** Accepting requests or chatting with unknown people.
- ◆ **Taking risks:** Clicking on strange links or downloading from untrusted websites.
- ◆ **Copying others:** Using someone else's work or pictures without asking them first.
- ◆ **Ignoring rules:** Ignoring rules leads to inappropriate behavior.

5.2 Cyberbullying:

Cyberbullying means using Internet devices like phones, computers, or tablets to intentionally hurt someone online. This includes sending mean messages, sharing embarrassing photos, or spreading lies.

5.2.1 Forms of Cyberbullying:

i) Harassment:

Harassment means someone is repeatedly sending mean or threatening messages to another person on social media. For example, when Ali keeps sending angry messages to Hassan on WhatsApp, calling him names and making fun of him, Hassan feels very sad he may lose his self-confidence.



Figure 5.1:

An illustration of cyberbullying



Hassan feels very sad; he may lose his self-confidence

Figure 5.2: An Illustration of Harassment

ii) Impersonation:

When someone pretends to be another person online to post rude or hurtful things. For example, Sara created a fake Facebook account using Amina's name and photo and then posted rude comments, making people think Amina was being meant.



Figure 5.3:

An Illustration of impersonation

iii) Outing:

When someone shares another person's private or embarrassing information online without their permission. For example, Hamza shared a screenshot of Ali's personal message in a group chat, and others laughed at Ali.



Figure 5.4:
An Illustration of Outing

iv) Exclusion:

Leaving someone out of a chat group for any reason or intention can make them feel hurt. Hira and her friends made a group chat to plan a class party, but they did not add Fatima on purpose. They talked about the party in front of her, making her feel left out.

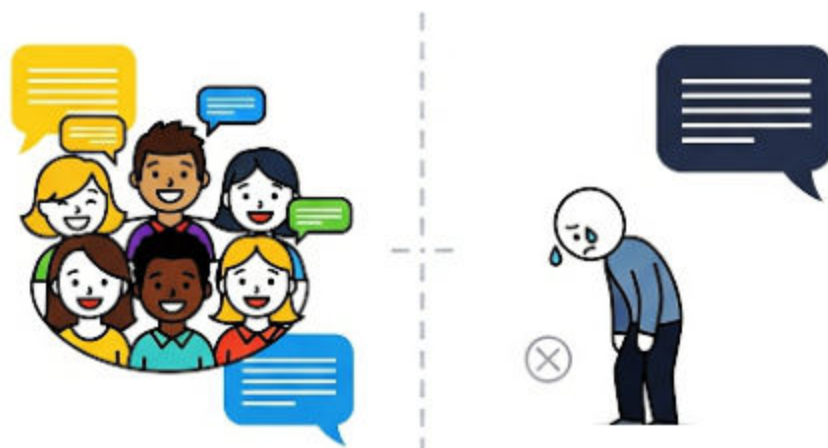


Figure 5.5: An Illustration of Exclusion

v) Cyberstalking:

When someone keeps watching, messaging, or following another person online in a way that feels scary or makes them uncomfortable. For example a girl keeps checking her classmate's posts, sends messages every day, and follows her in all online games, even after being asked to stop.



Figure 5.6:
An Illustration of Cyberstalking

5.2.2 Dealing with Cyberbullying:

Below are some safety steps one can take if someone is being cyberbullied

i) Tell a trusted adult:

Talk to a parent, teacher, school counselor, or any trusted adult.



Figure 5.7: An illustration of telling trusted elders

ii) Do not respond or fight back:

Stay calm. Replying can make things worse.



Figure 5.8: An illustration to not respond or fight back

iii) Block the bully:

Use the app's settings to block the person sending hurtful messages.



Figure 5.9: An illustration of block the bully

iv) Report the bully:

Report the post or user to the platform (like Facebook, Instagram, or TikTok).



Figure 5.10: An illustration of report the bully

v) Save the evidence:

Take screenshots or keep messages as proof to show a trusted adult.

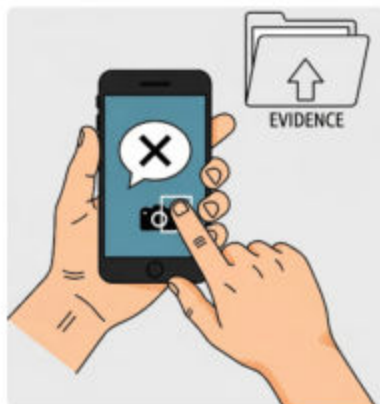


Figure 5.11: An illustration of saving the evidence

vi) Stay safe online:

Avoid sharing personal details and set your profiles to private.

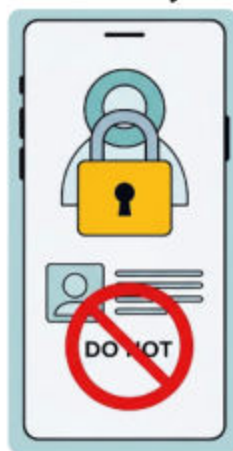


Figure 5.12: An illustration of stay safe online

5.3 Netiquettes:

Netiquette is a combination of the words "network" and "etiquette." It means showing courtesy and politeness when communicating and interacting with others while using the Internet and social media apps like WhatsApp, Facebook, Instagram, Snapchat, Twitter(x) and TikTok.

5.3.1 Importance of netiquette:

- ◆ It helps to stay kind and respectful, even when chatting or posting online.
- ◆ It reminds one to think before typing to avoid accidentally hurting someone's feelings.
- ◆ It teaches to respect each other's personal information and privacy.
- ◆ It helps to make good friends online and enjoy safe, fun experiences.
- ◆ It teaches healthy mental habits and helps one stay smart when using the Internet in the right way.



Figure 5.13: An illustration of importance of netiquettes

5.3.2 Importance of being Safe:

While using apps like WhatsApp, Facebook, TikTok, Snapchat, Instagram, YouTube, and Twitter (X), one should always keep personal information private. This helps to be safe from strangers and bad things online. Below are the tips to follow to stay safe.

- ◆ Never share full name, home address, phone number, or school name with strangers.
- ◆ Use a strong password to keep account safe, for example password: 2014@12Sun!
- ◆ If someone is being mean or sending weird messages, block and report it to a trusted adult.
- ◆ Keeping safe online is just as important as staying safe on the playground.



Figure 5.14: An illustration of keep information safe with strong password.

5.3.3 Importance of be responsible:

It is important to be responsible by thinking carefully before posting or sharing anything on apps like WhatsApp, Twitter(X), Snapchat, and Instagram. One should take care if sharing is kind, true, and safe for everyone to read.



Figure 5.15: An illustration of being responsible.

5.3.4 Importance of be respectful:

It is important to be kind while using social media platforms. To gain respect, one must avoid posting mean comments, making hurtful jokes, or sharing someone's private information.

Activity1: Online Safety" Poster Activity

Objective: To help students create a visual reminder of how to be safe and responsible online.

Activity:

1. **Create a Team:** Work with a partner to make a poster.
2. **Choose a Title:** Give poster a catchy name like "Online Safety Squad" or "Be a Good Digital Citizen."
3. **Draw and Write "Do's":** On poster, draw and write examples of what one *should* do online, like using polite language or asking an adult for help.
4. **Draw and Write "Don'ts":** Next, draw and write examples of what one *should not* do online, like sharing private photos or spreading rumors.
5. **Display:** Hang completed posters in the classroom to help everyone remember rules of online safety.



Figure 5.16:
An illustration of
being respectful.

5.4 Bias on Digital Platform:

Digital platform biasness happen when social media users, news reporters, TV hosts, or even famous people share information online in a way that is unfair or presents only one side of a story. Anyone who uses digital platforms to spread information that favors a particular viewpoint or group, often by highlighting certain facts and ignoring others, is contributing to this bias. This skewed presentation of information on the Internet is digital platform biasness.



On Instagram, someone may post only happy moments and hide sad ones.

Instagram

On facebook, a post may support one person in a fight without showing the full story.



Facebook



On X (Twitter), a message may blame someone without proof.

X (Twitter)

News channels may talk only about one side of an event.



Channels

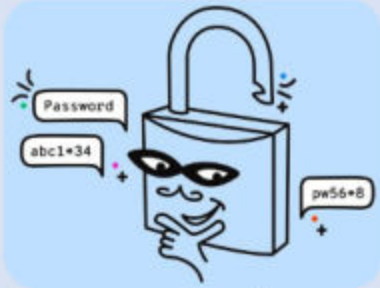
Figure 5.13: An illustration of biasness on digital platform.

5.5 Improper uses of computer resources:

- i) **Using someone else's login without permission:**
Illegal logging in with a friend's ID or password.
- ii) **Playing games during class time:**
Downloading games or tools that teacher or school did not allow.
- iii) **Installing or changing someone else's work:**
Removing a classmate's project from a shared folder.
- iv) **Deleting or changing someone else's work:**
Removing a classmate's project from a shared folder.
- v) **Sharing personal or private information:**
Posting someone's address or phone number on social media.
- vi) **Copying rude or mean messages:**
Writing hurtful comments in a group chat or on school forums.

5.6 Computer Threats:

A computer threat is anything that can harm a computer, network, or the information stored in them. It can cause damage, steal private information, or stop the computer from working properly. Below are some examples of Computer Threats.

#	Threat	Definition	Protection from Threats
1	Weak Passwords	 Someone can easily guess password if it's too simple like "1234".	Use a strong password with letters and numbers like P@\$Swo&d. Keep it secret.
2	Phishing	 Someone sends a fake email or message to steal user's password or personal info.	Do not click strange messages. Ask an adult first.

3	Fake Websites	 Someone makes a website that looks real to trick people.	Fake sites often have spelling mistakes (like faceboook.com instead of facebook.com). Safe sites start with https:// and show a lock  symbol.
4	Hacking	 Someone gets access into computer, email or social media account without permission.	Use a strong password. Always log out. Do not click unknown links.
5	Malware	 Someone tricks users into downloading a file that harms user computer.	Do not download unknown files. Use antivirus software.
6	Virus	 Someone spreads a bad computer program that can break or delete files.	Do not open strange files. Use Licensed antivirus.

7	Ransomware	 Someone locks computer files and asks for money to unlock them.	Do not open unknown files. Back up work.
8	Spyware	 Someone secretly installs a program on a user's computer to watch what user does.	Ask elders before installing any apps. Use safe programs only.
9	Spam	 Someone sends lots of junk messages or emails with bad links.	Delete junk messages. Do not click strange links.
10	Vandalism	 Someone deletes or breaks other people's files on purpose.	Respect others work. Do not change or delete their files.

5.7 Positive and Negative Impacts Of Using Social Media:

Social Media Platform	Definition	✓ Positive Use	✗ Negative Use
Facebook	A social networking site for sharing posts, pictures, and chatting with family and friends.	Online: Talk to family, join learning groups Offline: Feel happy and stay in touch	Online: viewing mean, sharing fake posts, exposure to propaganda Offline: May waste time or feel sad
Tube	A video platform for watching, sharing, and creating videos.	Online: Watch lessons, tutorials to learn skills. Offline: Improve school work, stay creative	Online: Watching inappropriate videos Offline: Eye strain or late sleeping
Instagram	An app for sharing photos, short videos (Reels), and stories.	Online: Exchanging personal talent and creative ideas. Offline: Finding new ideas and getting appreciation for work	Online: See fake or overly-edited pictures and be exposed to hurtful comments. Offline: May lead to feeling bad about yourself or trying to copy others.
TikTok	An app for creating and watching short, entertaining videos.	Online: Produce creative videos and share content. Offline: Discover new practice and skills.	Online: Follow silly or dangerous trends, or become addicted to scrolling. Offline: May cause user to neglect homework, chores, or real-life activities.

WhatsApp	WhatsApp is an app to share messages, pictures, videos and calls using the Internet. It is also used for school assignments and online classes.	Online: Talk to friends or teachers Offline: Feel close to loved ones	Online: May be used to spread fake news or rumors. Offline: May lead to a strong dependence on phone, making it hard to focus.
Snapchat	Snapchat is an app where user can share photos and short videos. User can also use fun filters that change how it looks and add effects to pictures.	Online: Share quick, fun moments with friends. Offline: Feel connected and cheerful throughout the day.	Online: May be used to send inappropriate or unsafe photos. Offline: Could lead to privacy issues or loss of focus of user surroundings.
Twitter (X)	Twitter (now called X) is an app where user can share short messages, news, and ideas with people all over the world.	Online: User can learn news fast, follow teachers or leaders, and share our ideas. Offline: User can discuss useful news with friends or in class.	Online: Fake news and mean comments can spread. Offline: Too much use may stop us from talking face-to-face.
LinkedIn	LinkedIn is an app where people share their jobs, skills, and learning to connect with others.	Online: User can learn about jobs, careers, and get study tips. Offline: User can use the knowledge to plan our future studies.	Online: Some people may copy or misuse our info. Offline: It may lead children to think about careers instead of school education.

Tip for Offline

Offline means things that user does in real life, not on the Internet.



Summary

- ◆ **Digital Environment:** The online world you enter when you use a computer, phone, or tablet to connect to the internet.
- ◆ **Appropriate Online Behavior:** Be kind, respect friends' privacy, use strong passwords, and tell an adult if something wrong is seen.
- ◆ **Inappropriate Online Behavior:** Do not bully people, share private information, talk to strangers, or click on strange links.
- ◆ **Cyber bullying:** Using technology to hurt, embarrass, or scare someone again and again.
- ◆ **Dealing with cyber bullying:** Tell a trusted adult, do not reply to the bully, block them, and save the evidence.
- ◆ **Netiquette:** The rules for being polite and respectful online.
- ◆ **Harassment:** Repeatedly sending mean, insulting, or threatening messages to someone online.
- ◆ **Impersonation:** Pretending to be someone else online by using their name or photos to post rude or hurtful things.
- ◆ **Outing:** Sharing someone's private or embarrassing information online without their permission.
- ◆ **Exclusion:** Intentionally leaving someone out of an online group, chat, or activity to make them feel hurt and alone.
- ◆ **Cyberstalking:** Repeatedly watching, messaging, or following someone online in a way that makes them feel scared or uncomfortable.
- ◆ **Bias:** When information online is unfair and only shows one side of a story.
- ◆ **Computer Threat:** A computer threat is anything that can harm a computer, network, or the information stored in them. It can cause damage, steal private information, or stop the computer from working properly.
- ◆ **Phishing:** When someone sends a fake message to trick you into sharing your password or personal information.
- ◆ **Hacking:** When someone gets into your computer or online accounts without permission.
- ◆ **Malware:** A harmful program that can damage user computer.
- ◆ **Virus:** A bad program that can copy itself and spread, deleting or damaging files.
- ◆ **Spam:** Unwanted, junk messages or emails, often sent to many people at once, usually containing ads or bad links.
- ◆ **Ransomware:** A type of malicious software that locks your computer files and demands money to unlock them.

EXERCISE

1. Encircle the correct answer:

- i. Which of the following is an example of appropriate behavior online?
- (a) Sharing someone's private photos
 - (b) Spreading false information
 - (c) Using polite language in messages
 - (d) Ignoring cyberbullying
- ii. What does the term 'netiquette' refer to?
- (a) The study of computer viruses
 - (b) Proper and respectful behavior on the Internet
 - (c) Illegal online activities
 - (d) Rules for online shopping
- iii. Which one is a positive impact of using social media?
- (a) Online scams
 - (b) Making global friends and learning
 - (c) Cyberbullying
 - (d) Addiction to screen time
- iv. Which one is a proper way to protect a computer from viruses?
- (a) Disabling the firewall
 - (b) Sharing r password
 - (c) Opening unknown email attachments
 - (d) Installing antivirus software
- v. What does digital bias mean?
- (a) Treating all opinions fairly
 - (b) Spreading rumors
 - (c) Treating people unfairly online
 - (d) Sharing someone personal data

2. Fill in the blanks with appropriate given words:

- i) Respecting others' opinions is an example of _____ behavior online.
- ii) _____ software helps protect device from viruses.
- iii) Sending _____ messages to a classmate on a game chat is an example of cyberbullying.
- iv) Spreading _____ about someone is an inappropriate action.
- v) Downloading _____ software is an example of improper use of computer resources.

3. Provide descriptive answers of the following questions.

- i) What is netiquette?
- ii) What is cyberbullying?
- iii) Name one positive effect of using social media.
- iv) What is digital bias?
- v) What is a computer threat? Give any five examples of computer threats.



Class Activity 1

Read each action below. Put a ✓ in the box that shows the action is **Appropriate** or **Inappropriate**.

Action	Appropriate (✓)	Inappropriate (✓)
Helping a friend who forgot their homework.	☐	☐
Reporting cyberbullying or any harmful behavior to a trusted adult	☐	☐
Visiting safe websites and asking an adult before downloading apps or files	☐	☐
Ignoring a friend who fell and got hurt.	☐	☐
Saying “please” and “thank ” politely.	☐	☐
Spreading rumors about someone.	☐	☐



Class Activity 2

Read each situation below. Put a ✓ in the box that shows an example of Cyberbullying or Not Cyberbullying.

Situation	Cyberbullying (✓)	Not Cyberbullying (✓)
Your friend sends a funny video of a cat.	☐	☐
Someone sends mean messages to your classmate on a game chat.	☐	☐
You accidentally send a text message to a wrong person by WhatsApp.	☐	☐
A person posts an embarrassing picture of another student online without permission.	☐	☐
Someone keeps excluding from an online group where your friends are.	☐	☐
Your teacher sends a link to an educational video.	☐	☐



Instructions for Teachers

- Teachers should emphasize active learning, demonstrations, and learner-centered methods in the classroom.
- Teacher should encourage hands-on activities, role-playing, and group work instead of relying only on lectures.
- Teachers should also create a supportive environment that promotes responsible digital citizenship.
- The focus should be on building practical skills, helping students learn to use online tools safely, responsibly, and respectfully in their daily lives.